
USC TROY PHILIPPINES
PRESENTS 33RD ANNUAL

PILIPINX AMERICAN
CULTURE NIGHT

Pamana

SUNDAY, APRIL 20, 2025
7:00 PM - 9:00 PM

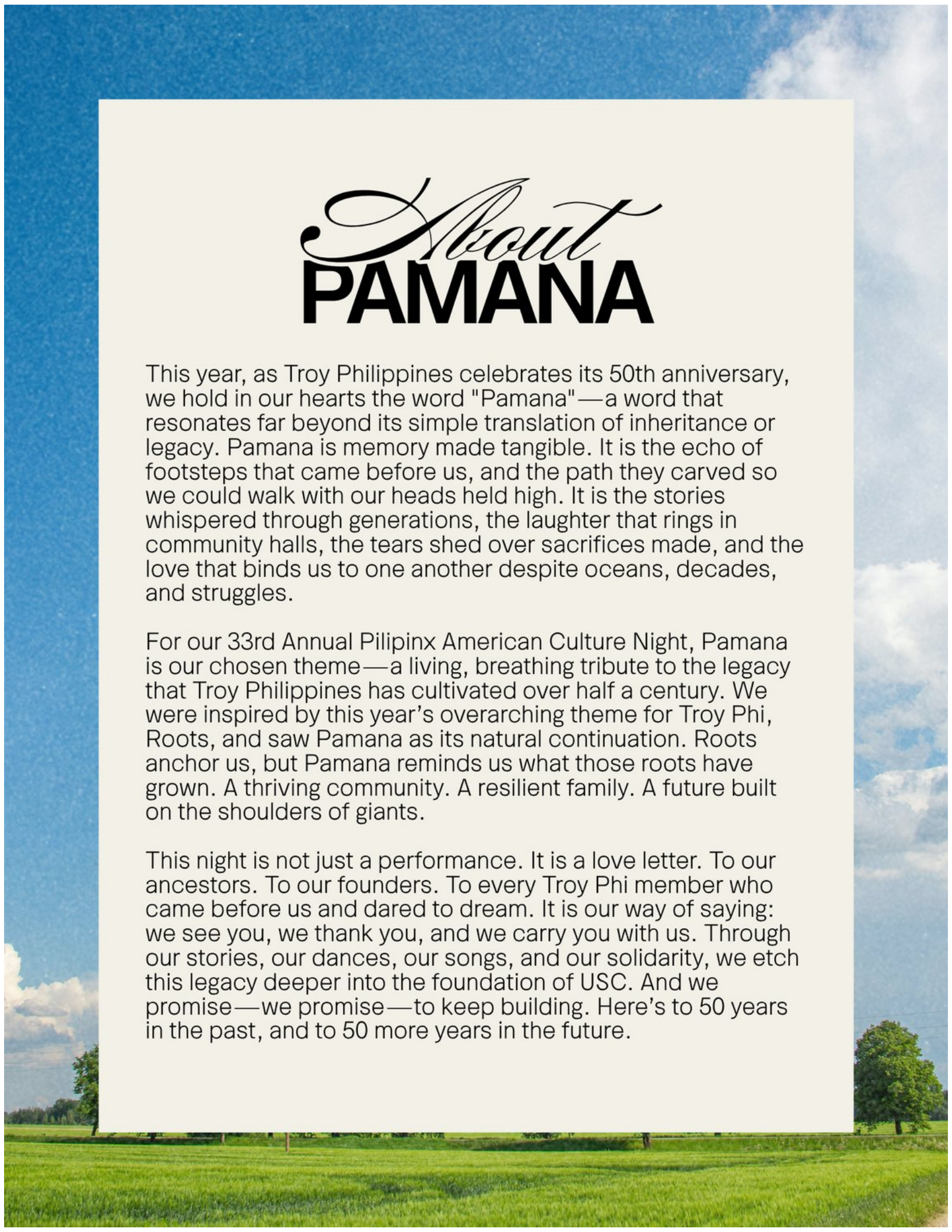
TROJAN GRAND BALLROOM
UNIVERSITY OF
SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Special Thanks



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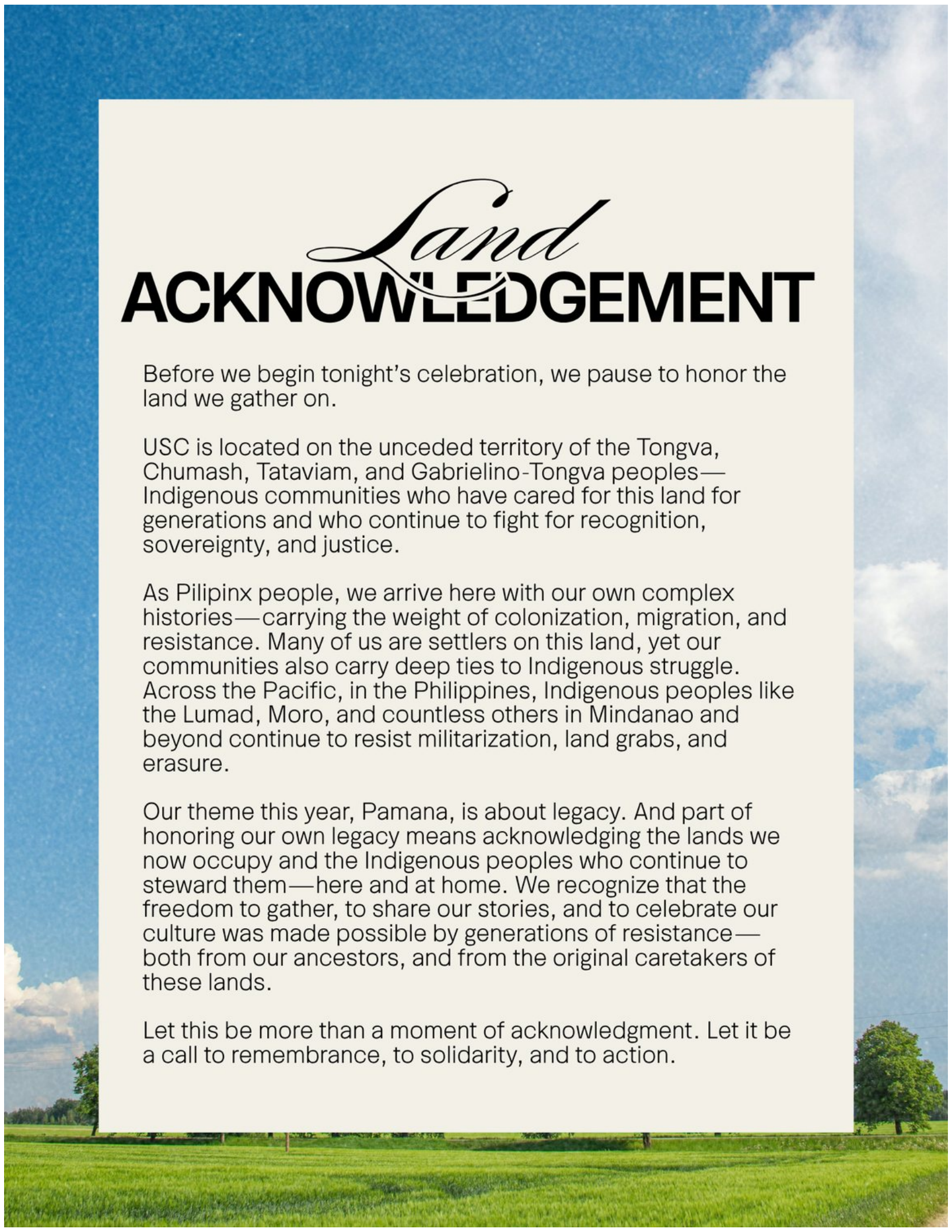


About **PAMANA**

This year, as Troy Philippines celebrates its 50th anniversary, we hold in our hearts the word "Pamana"—a word that resonates far beyond its simple translation of inheritance or legacy. Pamana is memory made tangible. It is the echo of footsteps that came before us, and the path they carved so we could walk with our heads held high. It is the stories whispered through generations, the laughter that rings in community halls, the tears shed over sacrifices made, and the love that binds us to one another despite oceans, decades, and struggles.

For our 33rd Annual Pilipinx American Culture Night, Pamana is our chosen theme—a living, breathing tribute to the legacy that Troy Philippines has cultivated over half a century. We were inspired by this year's overarching theme for Troy Phi, Roots, and saw Pamana as its natural continuation. Roots anchor us, but Pamana reminds us what those roots have grown. A thriving community. A resilient family. A future built on the shoulders of giants.

This night is not just a performance. It is a love letter. To our ancestors. To our founders. To every Troy Phi member who came before us and dared to dream. It is our way of saying: we see you, we thank you, and we carry you with us. Through our stories, our dances, our songs, and our solidarity, we etch this legacy deeper into the foundation of USC. And we promise—we promise—to keep building. Here's to 50 years in the past, and to 50 more years in the future.



Land **ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**

Before we begin tonight's celebration, we pause to honor the land we gather on.

USC is located on the unceded territory of the Tongva, Chumash, Tataviam, and Gabrielino-Tongva peoples—Indigenous communities who have cared for this land for generations and who continue to fight for recognition, sovereignty, and justice.

As Pilipinx people, we arrive here with our own complex histories—carrying the weight of colonization, migration, and resistance. Many of us are settlers on this land, yet our communities also carry deep ties to Indigenous struggle. Across the Pacific, in the Philippines, Indigenous peoples like the Lumad, Moro, and countless others in Mindanao and beyond continue to resist militarization, land grabs, and erasure.

Our theme this year, Pamana, is about legacy. And part of honoring our own legacy means acknowledging the lands we now occupy and the Indigenous peoples who continue to steward them—here and at home. We recognize that the freedom to gather, to share our stories, and to celebrate our culture was made possible by generations of resistance—both from our ancestors, and from the original caretakers of these lands.

Let this be more than a moment of acknowledgment. Let it be a call to remembrance, to solidarity, and to action.

Notes from **OUR PRESIDENT**

Maraming salamat sa inyong lahat! Thank you very much for attending our annual Pilipinx American Culture Night! Tonight is dedicated to the countless hours of practice that Troy Philippines' members have spent to create this show for you all. I am so grateful to have such a hardworking and talented community at USC come together to celebrate our shared identity as Filipinos.

This year, I am proud to announce that Troy Philippines is celebrating its 50th Anniversary. That is 50 years of cementing our place at this university and 50 years of ensuring that our presence does not go unnoticed.

As Filipinos, we yearn to perform and often seek comfort in our community of shared identity. This celebration of our culture is one of my favorite events of the year as I feel that it exemplifies exactly these values and the reason why I am certain we will be here for 50 more years to come.

After long nights of learning dances, building friendships and making memories, I am very excited to finally share what this community has built together with you all. Please enjoy our show.

Para sa kultura at para sa pagmamahal,
For the love and for the culture,
Nicole Concepcion
Troy Philippines President 2024-2025



Notes from **PACE DIRECTORS**

Welcome to this year's show, and thank you for being here to share this incredibly special moment with us. This year marks 50 years of Troy Phi—half a century of culture, community, and connection. As directors, we are humbled and honored to carry forward a legacy that has uplifted generations of Pilipinx voices here at USC. What began as a small space for cultural expression has grown into a powerful tradition—one that continues to evolve, inspire, and bring people together.

In looking back on the past five decades, we're reminded of the resilience and strength of our community. Of the students who built this space from the ground up. Of the artists and leaders who dared to tell our stories, even when the world wasn't ready to listen. We honor their courage, their creativity, and the foundation they've laid for all of us. Without them, this stage would not exist—and neither would we, in the way we are today: proud, connected, and empowered.

As we honor the last 50 years, we also dream boldly of the next 50. We imagine a future where this community continues to grow, where our stories are celebrated even more widely, and where each new generation feels even more empowered to take up space. We hope this show reflects not only where we've come from, but the limitless possibility of where we're going.

Maraming Salamat Po!

Derek Ann, Joshua Guico, Ivan Recinto

Notes from **OUR ADVISORS**

Mainit na pagbati and warm greetings! We welcome all TP members, alumni, family, and friends to Troy Philippines' 33rd Annual Pilipinx American Cultural Night (PACN) celebration. How fitting that "Pamana" (the Tagalog word for Legacy) is the theme of tonight's PACN show. Since 1975, USC's Troy Philippines (TP) has promoted culture and heritage, personal growth, and shaped the lives of countless USC Pilipinx students for the better. TP's greatest legacy is our thousands of TP alumni who have made a positive impact in the world.

In honor of the 50th Anniversary of USC Troy Philippines we launched a new fundraising campaign called the Troy Philippines Legacy Fund. The purpose of the Legacy fund is to support the organization's mission including cultural and social activities, meeting space and storage needs, and educational scholarships. Donation information and QR codes are displayed throughout the ballroom. Your donation-no matter the amount- will ensure that Troy Philippines will be around to serve USC and our Pilipinx community for years to come. Please donate today!

Maraming Salamat Po! Thank you and enjoy the show!

Sincerely,

USC Troy Philippines Co-Advisors
Alex Montances & Taylor Trentham



From the **PACE DIRECTORS**

Stepping into this role has been a full-circle moment - from intern to director, from feeling disconnected to finally embracing pamana. Growing up in predominantly white environments, I often felt distant from roots. But through this past year, I've not only reconnected with my heritage - I've found pride, purpose, and, most importantly, community in it. It's been deeply inspiring to grow into the parts of myself that I once kept at distance. - Joshua Guico

I have performed in PACN my freshman and sophomore year, and I am excited to be directing it this year! I am proud of my co-directors, coordinators, and cast members for working hard all semester to showcase our Pamana and celebrate our vast Pilipinx culture. - Ivan Recinto



From the **PACE INTERNS**

Showcasing the beauty of the Philippines through performance has always been my favorite part of expressing our culture. I am truly grateful for how Troy Philippines has, after 50 years, continued to be a platform through which our Filipino Trojans can celebrate and honor our heritage, even transcending regional borders and time periods. Thank you to everyone who has shown up today; I hope you can all be able to truly feel the resilience and love for our roots through PACN: PAMANA! - Clare Dominique

I'm very thankful to assist with creating this year's PACN, especially when we're also celebrating Troy Philippines' 50th year anniversary and I'm glad that I get to help continue the tradition of spreading awareness of true Filipino culture. I'd like to also say thank you to all the PACN directors, performers and coordinators for building this masterpiece together. I hope this PACN displays how us Fil-Am Trojans strive to continue to keep our culture authentic and sticking to the roots of Filipino history. PAMANA forever! - Jhana Dizon

Staying connected to my roots was something I always wanted to practice in college. Being an intern this semester has given me an avenue to do just that. With 50 years of rich history, Troy Philippines is an organization I hold close to my heart, and I'm incredibly grateful to contribute to a beautiful, meaningful event. Just like I have, I hope everyone gets an avenue to stay connected to our cultural roots through PACN: Pamana. - Angelica Baclig

PACN is one of the things that makes me feel closest to everyone in Troy Philippines as we come together with the drive to create a beautiful performance! I'm honored to be a part of the team planning it and to coordinate both Tinikling dances. I feel more connected to my roots than ever, and I'm really excited to see everyone see the love that we put into celebrating our culture. PAMANA forever!!
- Alex Johnston

Pacn CAST MEMBERS



AJ DOMINGO



ABBE PINGOL



ALEX JOHNSTON



**ALEXIE SAFIYA
ILAGA**



**ALYSSA NOELLE
GARCIA**



**ANDREI MIKHAEL
GALURA**



ANGELICA BACLIG



**ANMARY
BAUTISTA**



**ARRIANAH
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**CARMELO XAVIER
GERON**



CHAD CRISOSTOMO



CHELLE CANLAS



CHEYENNE SIMON



**CLARE DOMINIQUE
SANCHEZ**



**CHRISTIAN
DOTIMAS**



COLLEEN GAPUZAN



DANEL LIGON



DAVIN JENG



DEREK ANN



DESIREE ADAMOS



EPHRAIM DE LA CRUZ



ERIN CAPISONDA



ETHAN BURIEL



FLOYD NOSTRATIS



GAVYN TEFORA



HUNTER BLACK



ISABELLE CARIG



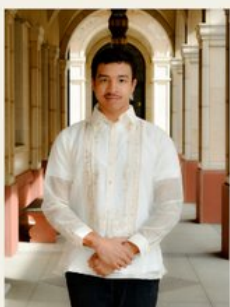
ISAIAH SANGKAY



IVAN RECINTO



IZZY TIAMSON



JACOB KITT



JAMIE ANCOG



JHANA DIZON



JIRAH DOMINGO



JOAQUIN ILAGAN



JOHN WEHN



JOJO IBALIO



JOSH NICOLAS



JOSHUA GUICO



JOSHUA SAMORTIN



KYLA PENAMANTE



KYLO MALLARI



LILY WOO



MADISON OMEGA



MARC GUMANGAN



MAYA ANDRES



MEGAN POBLETE



MICHAEL YOUNG



MYLIE RODRIGO



**NICOLE
CONCEPCION**



PHILIP MILLER



**REBECCA
VILLACORTE**



RICHARD OCHOA



SAM ABALAYAN



SEYMOUR THOMAS



THEA LISCANO



TYLEN BELL

Dance **PERFORMANCES** **MAGLALATIK**

coordinated by Michael Young

dancers: Floyd Nostratis, Jacob Kitt, Joaquin Ilagan,
Joshua Samortin

from the Maglalatik coordinator: Maglalatik is a traditional
Filipino folk dance that depicts a mock battle between two
groups over latik, a coconut-based delicacy. The dance is
performed by male dancers who wear coconut shells.
Choreography credited to Sherwin Magallanes.

BULAKLAKAN

coordinated by Clare Dominique Sanchez

dancers: Alyssa Noelle Garcia, Angelica Baclig, Arrianah
Galvan, Cheyenne Simon, Clare Dominique Sanchez, Lily
Woo, Maya Andres, Rebecca Villacorte

from the Bulaklakan coordinator: Bulaklakan, also known as
the dance of the floral garlands, is a dance originating from
Bulacan. In Bulacan, known for its beautiful flowers,
Bulaklakan began as a form of relaxation for people in the
countryside to relax after a long day of work. The dance itself is
performed with a garland of flowers forming an arch above the
dances to represent the motions of a flower blooming.
Nowadays, in some regions, Bulaklakan is performed in the
month of May to celebrate the spring flowers, but in others, it is
performed during Holy Week to celebrate the Virgin Mary. The
tradition of Bulaklakan continues to the present as a testament
to the natural beauty of the Philippines.

Dance **PERFORMANCES**

MODERN

coordinated by Arrianah Galvan, Christian Dotimas, Desiree Adamos, & Mylie Rodrigo

dancers: Abbe Pingol, Alex Johnston, Alyssa Noelle Garcia, Andrei Mikhael Galura, Anmary Bautista, Arrianah Galvan, Carl Erise Bay, Christian Dotimas, Davin Jeng, Derek Ann, Ethan Buriel, Gavyn Tefora, Isabelle Carig, Ivan Recinto, Izzy Tiamson, Jacob Kitt, Jamie Ancog, Jirah Domingo, Jojo Ibalio, Joshua Guico, Kyla Penamante, Lily Woo, Madison Omega, Michael Young, Mylie Rodrigo, Nicole Concepcion, Seymour Thomas, Thea Liscano, Tylen Bell

from the Modern coordinators: Filipino Americans have been at the forefront of hip-hop dance culture since the 1970s and 1980s, particularly in California. As hip-hop gained popularity in the U.S., Filipino youth gravitated toward hip hop as a means of self-expression, community, and cultural identity. Our Modern Hip-Hop Coordinators (Mylie R., Arrianah G., Desiree A., & Christian D.) were inspired by these roots and wanted to highlight the relationships within our community and versatility of our Filipino identities. This set combines refreshing hip-hop styles from the Bay Area, San Diego, and Femme. We embrace hip-hop as a way to celebrate our heritage, make an artistic statement, and, most importantly, uplift our community.

Dance **PERFORMANCES**

PANDANGGO SA ILAW

coordinated by Nicole Concepcion

dancers: Angelica Baclig, Anmary Bautista, Ashlyn Castro, Lily Woo, Nicole Concepcion, Rebecca Villacorte

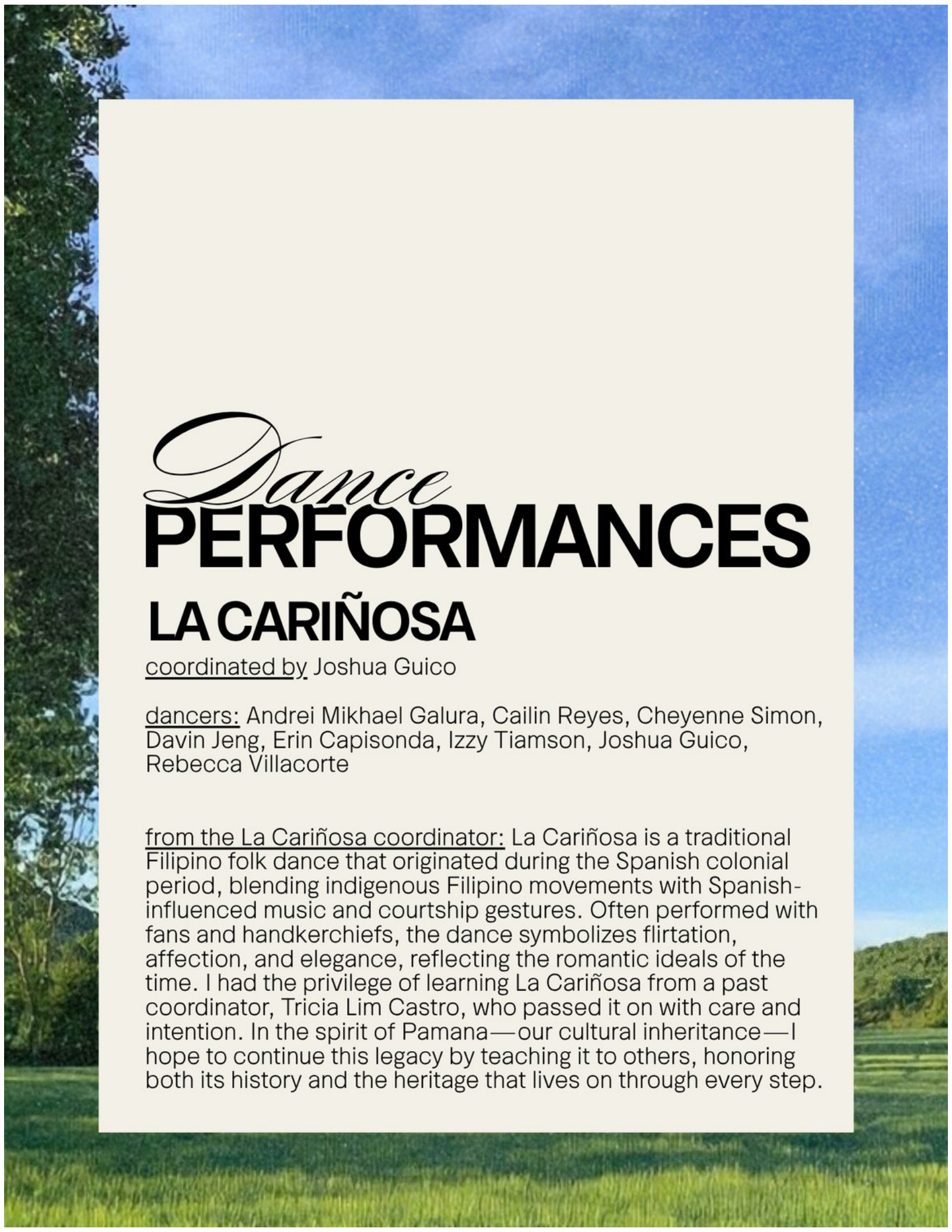
from the Pandanggo Sa Ilaw coordinator: Pandanggo sa Ilaw, translated to “fandango of lights”, originated during the Hispanic period in the Mindoro region. It evolved from the Spanish dance of the fandango and involves dancers demonstrating stability and grace by balancing candles on the backs of their hands and their heads. The dancers movements are said to imitate those of fireflies at night or the candles that would light the way for fishermen.

SAYAW SA BANGKO

coordinated by Nicole Concepcion

dancers: AJ Domingo, Ashlyn Castro, Derek Ann, Gavyn Tefora, Isabella Carig, Ivan Recinto, Joaquin Ilagan, Joshua Guico, Joshua Samortin, Kyla Penamante, Nicole Concepcion, Richard Ochoa Jr

from the Sayaw sa Bangko coordinator: Sayaw sa bangko, translated to “dance on bench,” is a Filipino folk dance originating from Pangasinan. It originated at wedding feasts where the newlywed couple would display their new union with the dance. It involves a barefoot couple dancing on a bench, swinging each other over and around, displaying their strength and control. Different configurations of the benches, including stacking them on top of each other, have added more suspense and intensity, adding to the spectacle and performance.

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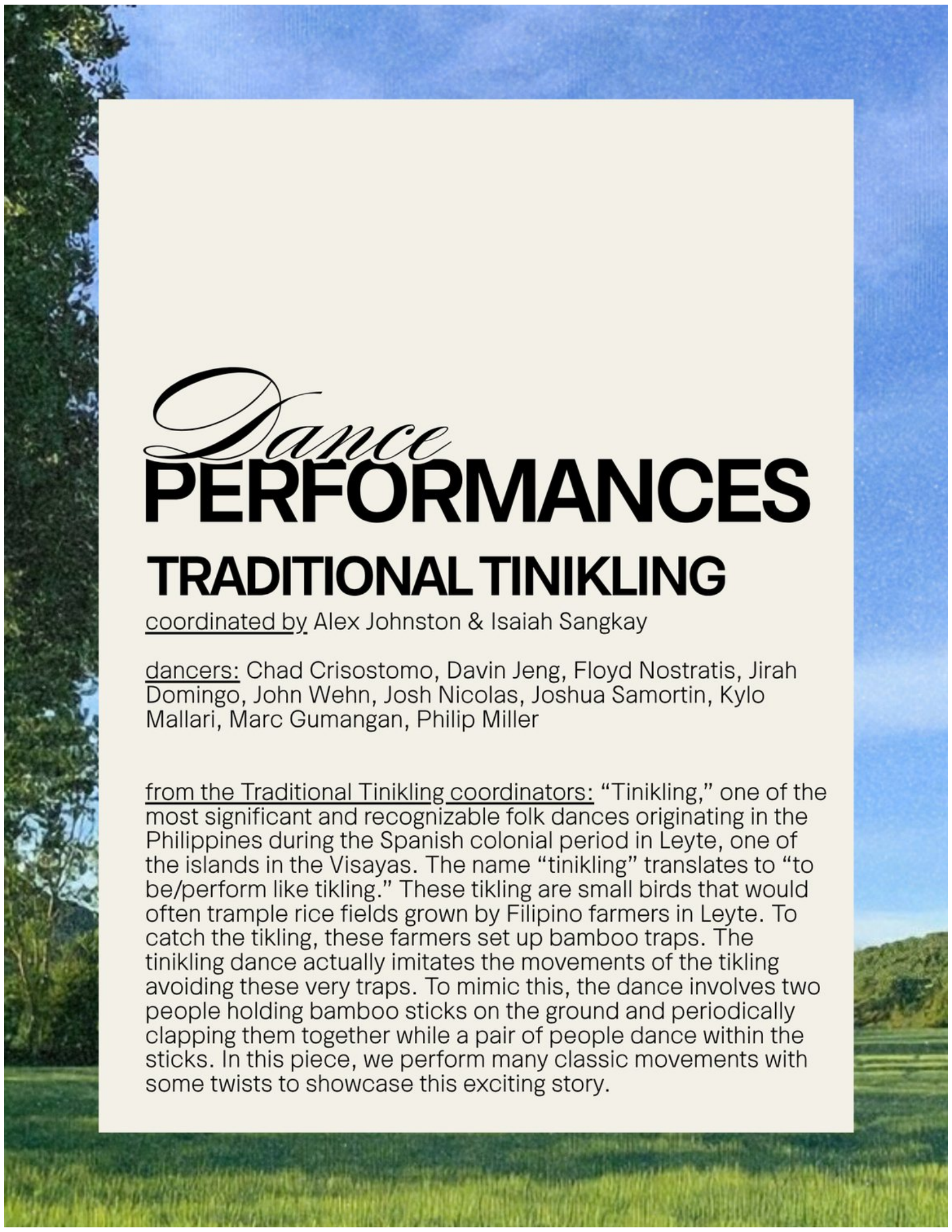
Dance **PERFORMANCES**

LA CARIÑOSA

coordinated by Joshua Guico

dancers: Andrei Mikhael Galura, Cailin Reyes, Cheyenne Simon, Davin Jeng, Erin Capisonda, Izzy Tiamson, Joshua Guico, Rebecca Villacorte

from the La Cariñosa coordinator: La Cariñosa is a traditional Filipino folk dance that originated during the Spanish colonial period, blending indigenous Filipino movements with Spanish-influenced music and courtship gestures. Often performed with fans and handkerchiefs, the dance symbolizes flirtation, affection, and elegance, reflecting the romantic ideals of the time. I had the privilege of learning La Cariñosa from a past coordinator, Tricia Lim Castro, who passed it on with care and intention. In the spirit of Pamana—our cultural inheritance—I hope to continue this legacy by teaching it to others, honoring both its history and the heritage that lives on through every step.

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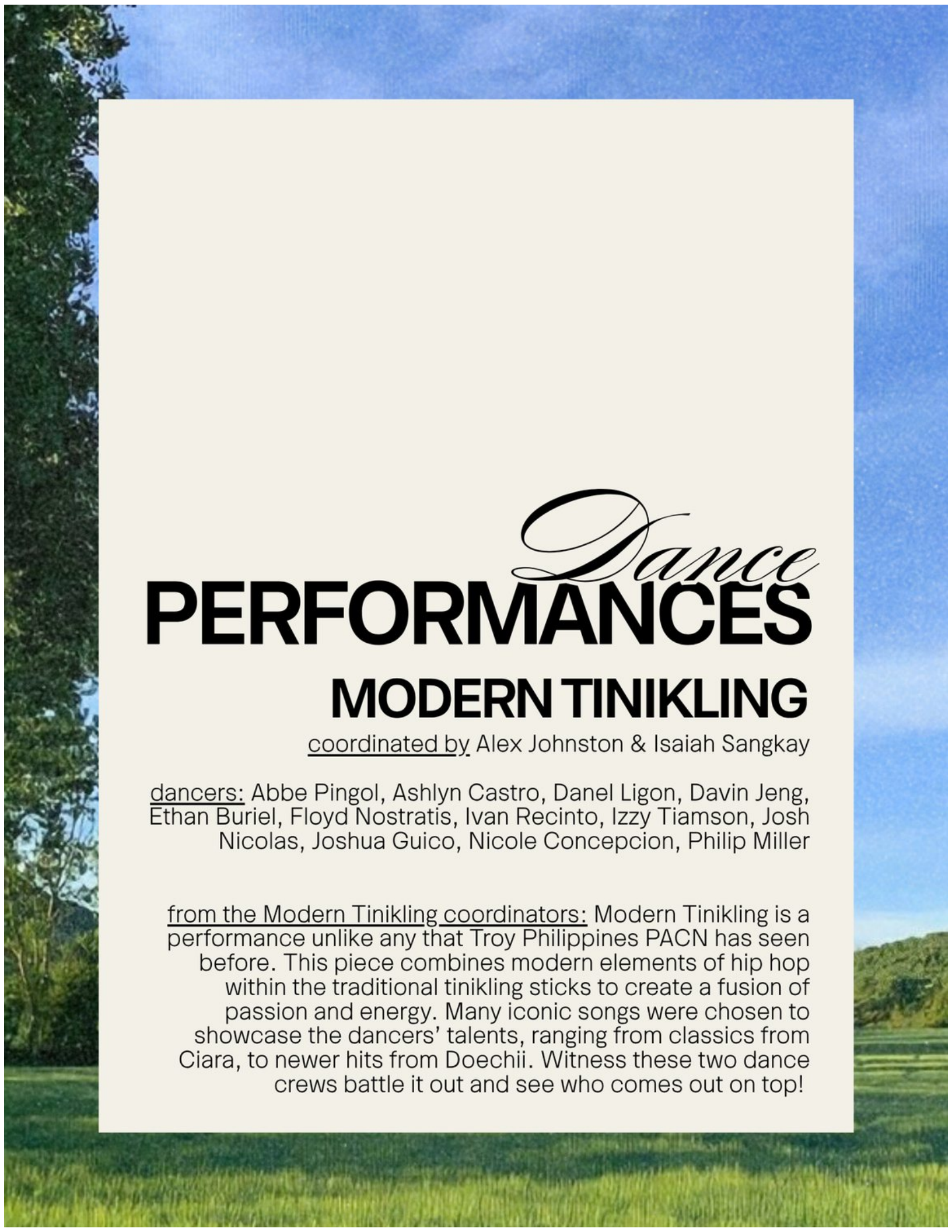
Dance **PERFORMANCES**

TRADITIONAL TINIKLING

coordinated by Alex Johnston & Isaiah Sangkay

dancers: Chad Crisostomo, Davin Jeng, Floyd Nostratis, Jirah Domingo, John Wehn, Josh Nicolas, Joshua Samortin, Kylo Mallari, Marc Gumangan, Philip Miller

from the Traditional Tinikling coordinators: “Tinikling,” one of the most significant and recognizable folk dances originating in the Philippines during the Spanish colonial period in Leyte, one of the islands in the Visayas. The name “tinikling” translates to “to be/perform like tikling.” These tikling are small birds that would often trample rice fields grown by Filipino farmers in Leyte. To catch the tikling, these farmers set up bamboo traps. The tinikling dance actually imitates the movements of the tikling avoiding these very traps. To mimic this, the dance involves two people holding bamboo sticks on the ground and periodically clapping them together while a pair of people dance within the sticks. In this piece, we perform many classic movements with some twists to showcase this exciting story.



Dance **PERFORMANCES**

MODERN TINIKLING

coordinated by Alex Johnston & Isaiah Sangkay

dancers: Abbe Pingol, Ashlyn Castro, Danel Ligon, Davin Jeng, Ethan Buriel, Floyd Nostratis, Ivan Recinto, Izzy Tiamson, Josh Nicolas, Joshua Guico, Nicole Concepcion, Philip Miller

from the Modern Tinikling coordinators: Modern Tinikling is a performance unlike any that Troy Philippines PACN has seen before. This piece combines modern elements of hip hop within the traditional tinikling sticks to create a fusion of passion and energy. Many iconic songs were chosen to showcase the dancers' talents, ranging from classics from Ciara, to newer hits from Doechii. Witness these two dance crews battle it out and see who comes out on top!

Musical **PERFORMANCES**

“PANALANGIN”

coordinated by Alyssa Noelle Garcia & Carmelo Xavier Geron

vocals by Abbe Pingol, Alex Johnston, Alyssa Noelle Garcia, Andrei Mikhael Galura, Arrianah Galvan, Carl Erise Bay, Cheyenne Simon, Floyd Nostratis, Isabelle Carig, Jojo Ibalio, Madison Omega, Richard Ochoa Jr, Sam Abalayan

from the TPV coordinators: “Panalangin” meaning “prayer” is a classic OPM piece illustrating the longing for being with the person you love for the rest of your life.

“HOW DEEP IS YOUR LOVE”

covered by Alexie Ilaga & Colleen Gapuzan

from the vocalists: "How Deep Is Your Love" by the Bee Gees is more than just a timeless ballad—it's a staple at Filipino gatherings, especially during family parties and karaoke nights. Its smooth harmonies and heartfelt lyrics made it a favorite among titos and titas, which was a significant memory to Colleen and Alexie growing up in a Filipino household. The song, like much of 70s and 80s soft rock and disco, struck a chord in Filipino culture, blending effortlessly with the community's deep appreciation for emotional storytelling and vocal prowess. For many, it became a rite of passage to sing it at karaoke, and have deep sentiment and nostalgia that helped shape a collective musical identity that bridged generations.

Musical **PERFORMANCES**

“WHEREVER YOU ARE”

covered by Chelle Canlas

from the vocalist: “Wherever You Are” by 5 Seconds of Summer is a heartfelt song about missing someone you love and holding onto hope that you’ll see them again. It feels like an open letter to someone far away, filled with honesty and longing. The acoustic sound and emotional lyrics capture how love can stick with you, even when someone isn’t around. It’s a reminder that love doesn’t always fade with distance—it can grow stronger, even if it hurts.

“MAPA”

coordinated by Alyssa Noelle Garcia & Carmelo Xavier Geron

vocals by Abbe Pingol, Alex Johnston, Alyssa Noelle Garcia, Andrei Mikhael Galura, Arrianah Galvan, Carl Erise Bay, Cheyenne Simon, Floyd Nostratis, Isabelle Carig, Jojo Ibalio, Madison Omega, Richard Ochoa Jr, Sam Abalayan

from the TPV coordinators: “MAPA” is a more modern OPM piece released in 2021. The name “MaPa” has a lot of symbolism in this song. Not only does it come from mixing Mama and Papa, it’s also the mix of the words “mata” meaning eyes and “paa” meaning feet. It’s a heartwarming song appreciating all the sacrifices our parents have made to give the best to their children. Parents are our map in this world and have helped guide our lives, teaching us what we need to succeed in this world.

Musical **PERFORMANCES**

“IKAW”

covered by Cheyenne Simon

from the vocalist: “Ikaw” by Yeng Constantino is a Filipino love song that expresses deep emotions of finding true love. The song carries a deep sense of sincerity while remaining simple. Cheyenne chose this song because it was one of her favorite as a young girl who was trying to discover what it is to live and love.

“BABALIK SA’YO”

coordinated by Alyssa Noelle Garcia & Carmelo Xavier Geron

vocals by Abbe Pingol, Alex Johnston, Alyssa Noelle Garcia, Andrei Mikhael Galura, Arrianah Galvan, Carl Erise Bay, Cheyenne Simon, Floyd Nostratis, Isabelle Carig, Jojo Ibalio, Madison Omega, Richard Ochoa Jr, Sam Abalayan

from the TPV coordinators: “Babalik Sa’yo” is another modern OPM piece speaking of the unpredictability of love. Love comes at us when we least expect it, by those whom we may have never expected. While a surprise, we’re ready to give our all towards that special someone in our lives.

Special **THANKS TO**

Isabelle Lacson (Class of 2008)
Maximillian Mark Medina/The Mystery Parade
Danica Hosaka (Class of 2019)
Floyd Nostratis
Charity Ann Gempesao
Garrick Guico
Roland Villegas
Ephraim Joseph De La Cruz
Adan Aguirre



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Ipagalog TRANSLATIONS

<u>Lola</u>	Grandma
<u>Kuya</u>	Older Brother
<u>Anak</u>	[my] child
<u>Tatay/Tay</u>	Father
<u>"Halika dito"</u>	"Come here"
<u>"Kasunduan na ito"</u>	"This is an agreement"
<u>Salamat</u>	Thank you
<u>Para saan</u>	"For what?"
<u>"Ay nako"</u>	"Bruh"
<u>Pogi</u>	Handsome
<u>Guapito</u>	Handsome person
<u>Paquito</u>	The name of a Filipino action star
<u>"ba talaga?"</u>	"Is it really?"
<u>Barkada</u>	Friends
<u>"Pero hindi ibig sabihin na dapat tayong matakot"</u>	"But that doesn't mean we should be afraid"
<u>Kumusta</u>	Hello/How are you
<u>Naalala ko</u>	I remember
<u>Ninong</u>	Godfather
<u>Tito</u>	Uncle
<u>Tita</u>	Aunt
<u>Yan ang ibig sabihin ng pamilya</u>	That's what family means
<u>Ma kulit</u>	stubborn
<u>"pero Pilipino pa rin siya"</u>	"He's still Filipino"
<u>Chismis</u>	Gossip
<u>"Landi landi ka dyan, baka bigla kang madapa"</u>	"You're acting flirty, you might trip"
<u>"[hin]di ba?"</u>	"Isn't that right?"
<u>Pogit</u>	Poor
<u>Putit</u>	White
<u>So totoo</u>	Really
<u>"Hindi ako makapaniwala"</u>	"I can't believe it"